

Verses of Auspiciousness

Svastigāthā · Toh 817 · Derge Kangyur

བད་ལེགས་ཀྱི་གིས་སྤུཅད་པ།

The Verses of Auspiciousness (Sanskrit: Svasti Gāthā; Tibetan: Bde legs kyi tshigs su bcad pa) is a short devotional text in verse, said to be drawn from the Sūtra of Entering the City. It opens with a god asking the Buddha what one should speak so that well-being may come about, and the Buddha answers by teaching verses of auspiciousness, promising that whoever recites them constantly will meet with good fortune. The verses go on to praise the Three Jewels, beginning with the incomparable treasure of the perfect Buddha, which no other riches in this or any other world can match. The work is Toh 817 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the tantra-section texts of a protective and benedictory kind, the sort of verses recited to invoke blessings and good omens.

This concludes the verses of auspiciousness drawn from the Sūtra of Entering the City.

In the language of India: Svasti Gāthā. In the language of Tibet: Verses of Auspiciousness. Homage to the Three Jewels.

A god approached, and having drawn near, he made a request to the god who is the object of offering: "Great Buddha, mighty Sage, what should one speak so that well-being may come about?" Having heard these words, the one who is the very root of the world gave this teaching: "Whoever constantly recites this, my verses of auspiciousness, will have well-being come to pass. Listen.

Whatever supreme and vast treasure exists in this world, in other worlds, or in the heavens, none of it can match the treasure of the perfect Buddha, not by reckoning, not by number, not even by a fraction. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the perfect Buddha, the precious one, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

The deathless nectar of peaceful cessation, vast and profound, which the Śākya Sage realized in his mind while resting in even equipoise, has no equal among teachings. One who has first practiced it will thereafter know no sorrow. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the sacred Dharma, the precious one, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

Those eight persons whom the Victor taught, who form four pairs of noble beings, are fields worthy of offerings, exceedingly rare upon the earth. What is given to them becomes immeasurable. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the Saṅgha, the precious one, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

The supreme sacred one, the foremost, the vast giver; the radiant hero, the abode of the supreme sacred; the sacred one of sacred wisdom, the most sacred of the sacred; knower of the highest, who is himself unequaled in his excellence: this is the one Blessed One. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the perfect Buddha, the precious one, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

The sacred absorption without interruption, which the Tathāgata of limitless intelligence taught, that stable absorption likened to a vajra, has no absorption equal to it. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious absorption, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

Just as a firm gate-post and a firm enclosing wall are not shaken by the four mighty winds, so too the wise one who abides, having seen the Four Truths, is not stirred here by those who speak worldly words. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the Saṅgha, the precious one, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

Overcoming all, knowing all, seeing all, omniscient, endowed with all the powers, the most sacred of all, free of all fear, knowing all intentions: this is the one Blessed One. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the perfect Buddha, the precious one, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

Existence is brought to cessation, unmoving, without change, flawless, utterly freed from all fears, a perfect cessation, vast and profound, a definite emergence, utterly stainless and peaceful, not to be carried off by the mind. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the sacred Dharma, the precious one, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

Those who see the truths that reveal utter suffering and grant happiness, and who are heedful...

Those who are free from doubt about the precious truths do not take an eighth rebirth. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious Saṅgha, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

The holy ones know the ultimate, the holy; they know the supreme and the not supreme, and they strive for the ultimate. They are not carried off by others, and they have realized and grasped the holy truth. They are the supreme helpers of those in utter suffering. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious perfect Buddha, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

Having generated aspiration, and having become endowed with yoga, they are ever diligent in the teaching of Gautama, utterly liberated and at peace. Not led by others, they touch that pure peace. For this one, that attainment does not come to be counted among the ordinary. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious Saṅgha, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

For one who has seen the truths, even if some wrongdoing should be committed through heedlessness or negligence, such a one is not fit to conceal or disguise it, for this nature of reality stands unmoving. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious Saṅgha, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

In all the worlds with their gods, there is none greater than the Buddha, nor any equal. He is the unsurpassed Teacher of gods and humans, supreme among teachers, guides, and healers. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious perfect Buddha, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

In the first month of spring, the Sage, in the forest grove, attained the holy Dharma. There is nothing greater than that Dharma, nor anything equal. For this one, that attainment does not come to be counted among the ordinary. Wondrous, utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious holy Dharma, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be complete well-being.

Old misdeeds are exhausted, and no new ones are made. Free of the plague of afflictions, they are fearless and without sorrow. With the root cut off, they generate no further becoming. The teaching will blaze like a lamp. Wondrous,

utterly marvelous, beyond measure is the precious Saṅgha, supreme in the world. By this truth, just as I have spoken it, may there be...

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence, with the final verse incomplete, so the last line is rendered as it stands. The opening line, which closes the previous text, belongs to the colophon of the preceding section. The word rendered "the god who is the object of offering" reflects a doubtful reading, and the verse about the sacred one in the fifth stanza is dense with epithets whose exact sense is uncertain; I have kept them close to the Tibetan. The "eight persons forming four pairs" are the four stages of the path, each with a person approaching and a person abiding in the fruit.
- This is the Ratana Sutta verse sequence (Sanskrit Ratnasūtra), here in a Tibetan rendering that is evidently loose and in places corrupt. The Tibetan lines about the first spring month and the forest grove, and about seeing the truths and heedlessness, correspond only roughly to the Pali; I have followed the Tibetan as it stands. The phrase "does not come to be counted among the ordinary" is uncertain; it parallels the Pali sense that such a one is not reckoned among ordinary beings. The final sentence breaks off at the end of the passage and is left incomplete, to be continued by the next passage.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.